PADHAKU
Exploring Society: India and Beyond · Class 6 Social Science



CHAPTER 2

Oceans and Continents

NCERT Exercise Solutions

Let's Explore · The Distribution of Water and Land on the Earth	4 Q
Think About It	2 Q
Let's Explore · Oceans	1 Q
Let's Explore · Continents	4 Q
Questions, activities and projects	6 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

Independent study aid by Beginers Point. Not an official NCERT publication.

Let's Explore · The Distribution of Water and Land on the Earth

1 **What are the circular lines in each map called? And what are the lines radiating out of the two poles called?**

✔ ANSWER

The circular lines are **parallels of latitude**.

The lines radiating out of the poles are **meridians of longitude**.

2 **Which hemisphere holds more water?**

✔ ANSWER

The **Southern Hemisphere** holds more water.

(The Northern Hemisphere has more land.)

3 **What could be the approximate proportion of water to land in the Northern Hemisphere? And in the Southern Hemisphere? Discuss in groups.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Northern Hemisphere: about **60 % water : 40 % land** (roughly 3 : 2).
- Southern Hemisphere: about **80 % water : 20 % land** (roughly 4 : 1).

4 **Are all the oceans connected with one another, or are there separations between**

them?

✔ ANSWER

All the oceans are **connected** with one another.

The lines dividing them on the map are only conventions; seawater flows freely across the oceans.

🤔 Think About It

1 **If there is such abundance of water on the planet, why is there so much talk of 'water scarcity' or a 'water crisis'?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Most of the Earth's water is in the oceans and is **salty**, so we cannot drink it or use it for farming.

Freshwater is only a very small part (in glaciers, rivers, lakes, the air and underground).

As people grow in number and waste or pollute water, there is not enough clean freshwater for everyone.

2 **What ways of saving water are you aware of? Which ones have you seen practised at home, at your school, and in your village, town or city?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Turning off taps while brushing; fixing leaking taps and pipes.
- Using a bucket instead of a shower or hose.
- Reusing water (e.g. water used to wash vegetables for plants).
- Rainwater harvesting on roofs (seen in schools and many buildings).
- Drip irrigation in fields; protecting ponds and lakes.

⭐ Let's Explore · Oceans

1 **Locate the five oceans and mark the hemisphere(s) they belong to.**

Ocean	Northern Hemisphere	Southern Hemisphere
Pacific Ocean		
Atlantic Ocean		
Indian Ocean		
Southern Ocean		
Arctic Ocean		

✔ ANSWER

Ocean	Northern Hemisphere	Southern Hemisphere

Pacific Ocean	✓	✓
Atlantic Ocean	✓	✓
Indian Ocean	✓ (small part)	✓ (most of it)
Southern Ocean	×	✓
Arctic Ocean	✓	×

⭐ Let's Explore · Continents

1 **Counting the numbers of squares, name the largest continent and the smallest.**

✔ ANSWER

Largest: **Asia**.

Smallest: **Australia**.

2 **Which one is larger — North America or South America? Africa or North America? Antarctica or Australia?**

✔ ANSWER

- **North America** is larger than South America.
- **Africa** is larger than North America.
- **Antarctica** is larger than Australia.

3 **Re-colour the diagram with a single colour for Europe and Asia and rename the result**

‘Eurasia’. Compare its size with South America’s.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Eurasia (Europe + Asia together) is the largest landmass.

It is about **three times as large** as South America.

4 **Write down the list of continents from the smallest to the largest.**

✔ ANSWER

Australia → Europe → Antarctica → South America → North America → Africa → Asia

? Questions, activities and projects

1 (a) **Explain the term: Continent**

✔ ANSWER

A continent is a **very large, continuous expanse of land** on the Earth's surface, e.g. Asia, Africa.

1 (b) **Explain the term: Ocean**

✔ ANSWER

An ocean is one of the **largest bodies of salty water** on the Earth, e.g. the Pacific Ocean.

All oceans are connected to each other.

1 (c) Explain the term: Island

✔ ANSWER

An island is a **piece of land surrounded by water on all sides** that is too small to be a continent, e.g. Greenland, the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

2 Let us draw – Without looking at the maps in this chapter, draw the continents free hand on a sheet of paper and colour them. Then compare your drawing with the map of oceans and continents in the chapter.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Activity: draw the seven continents from memory and colour each differently.

Then check with Fig. 2.3: Asia should be largest, Australia smallest, Antarctica at the bottom, the Americas to the left (west) and Africa below Europe.

3 Let us do – On the outline map of the world, label all the continents and oceans.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Label the 7 continents: Asia, Africa, North America, South America, Antarctica, Europe, Australia.

Label the 5 oceans: Pacific (between Asia–Australia and the Americas), Atlantic (between the Americas and Europe–Africa), Indian (south of Asia, between Africa and Australia), Southern (around Antarctica), Arctic (around the North Pole).

Use Fig. 2.3 to check your map.

4 **Solve the crossword.**

Across: 1. Abundantly produced by the oceans · 3. A large expanse of landmass · 6. A large continent of which India is a part · 8. A major source of pollution of the oceans · 10. The coldest continent

Down: 2. The largest island on Earth · 4. A huge destructive wave from the ocean · 5. The smallest continent · 7. The largest body of water on the Earth · 9. A landmass (but not a continent) surrounded by the sea or ocean

✔ ANSWER

Across: 1. OXYGEN · 3. CONTINENT · 6. ASIA · 8. PLASTIC · 10. ANTARCTICA

Down: 2. GREENLAND · 4. TSUNAMI · 5. AUSTRALIA · 7. PACIFIC (Ocean) · 9. ISLAND

🎉 **Chapter 2 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**